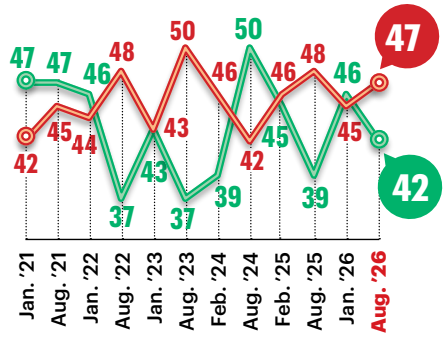


ARUN KUMAR

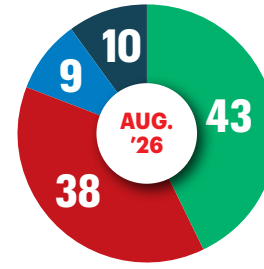
21
PER CENT
Muslims back Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls to remove bogus/ duplicate voters, compared with 60 per cent overall

Q. What do you think about the current state of democracy in India?



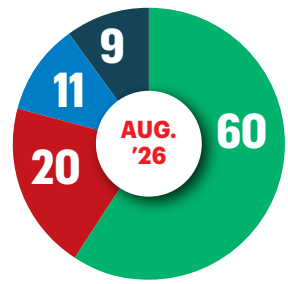
More respondents see democracy under threat, reversing January's trend

Q. Has your trust in the Election Commission of India increased or decreased over the past year?

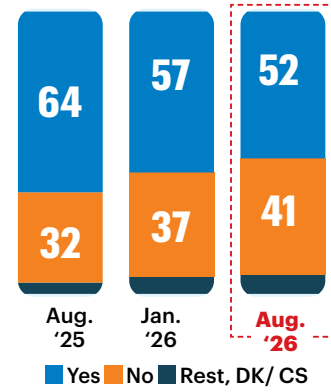


Voters remain more trusting of the Election Commission than its critics suggest

Q. The Election Commission's Special Intensive Revision (SIR) removed many names from electoral rolls. What is your view of this exercise?



Q. Do you believe elections in India are free and fair?



Confidence in free and fair elections has steadily eroded over the past year

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say

Indians appear increasingly impatient with the way institutions function, more suspicious of whether the system is fair and less willing to give governments the benefit of the doubt when things go wrong. Yet they continue to support several ideas central to the Narendra Modi-led Union government's political agenda—the Uniform Civil Code; One Nation, One Poll; and the push against illegal immigration.

That is a key message from the INDIA TODAY Mood of the Nation survey conducted in August 2026: a crisis of trust is developing beneath a remarkably resilient political consensus.

That uneasy mix is already visible on the streets. The Gen Z-led agitation against the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (NEET) paper leak that began at Jantar Mantar gathered enough momentum to force Union education minister Dharmendra Pradhan to resign. The anger then travelled. Jharkhand saw thousands of young people protesting alleged irregularities in recruitment examinations, followed by a similar confrontation with the authorities in Bihar. And within weeks of the NEET agitation, Jantar Mantar was again occupied, this time by people demanding changes to caste-based reservation. These are dif-